JBL Live Beam 4

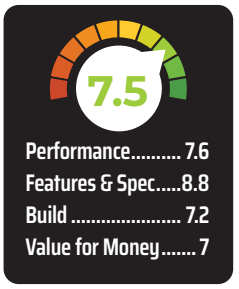
Punchy sound with smart features

The wireless earbuds market is crowded, and standing out takes more than good sound alone. JBL has been competing in this space for years, but the company has also been experimenting with ways to make its earbuds more than just a pair of audio accessories. Adding a touchscreen to the charging case is one such innovation, giving users greater control over their listening experience without having to reach for their phones. The all-new JBL Live Beam 4 is a prime example of this innovation from the company.

₹14,999



I spent time using the JBL Live Beam 4 to see how well its features translate into real-world performance. From sound quality and call performance to comfort, connectivity, and battery life, there is plenty to explore beyond the specifications sheet. The earbuds offer several useful personalisation options, although the companion app can occasionally feel cumbersome. So, does the JBL Live Beam 4 justify its premium positioning, or are there any everyday compromises that hold it back? Here is my experience with JBL Live Beam 4 companies' latest feature-packed wireless earbuds.



DESIGN AND BUILD

If you've used the JBL Live Beam 3, the new JBL Live Beam 4 may feel familiar. The earbuds and charging case look almost identical to the previous generation. The numbers back this up, too. Each Live Beam 4 earbud weighs 4.85 g, compared to 5 g for the Live Beam 3. The case weighs 73 g, just 1 g more than the previous model's 72 g. Both models also have an IP55 rating. JBL calls the new case 'redesigned', but in terms of looks and weight, it feels much the same as the old one.

One area where I feel there is room for improvement is the build quality. Although the device is lightweight, the plastic build, unchanged from the Live Beam 3, could have been more premium. The quality of the eartips, especially the rubber material, could also be improved for better comfort and durability.

The case is another area that could be improved, as at 73 g, it is considerably heavier than its competitors, which usually weigh around 50 to 55 g. Moreover, it also feels a little bulky, making it less convenient to carry in a pocket. While the touchscreen is a unique and useful feature, reducing the size and weight of the case could make the overall experience even better.

However, one thing that makes it different from the competition and its predecessors is its funky colour variants. While most rivals come in black, white or grey, the company offers the device in seven different finishes, notably black, blue, green, silver, orange, purple and sand. The device comes with an IP55 certification, ensuring that the earbuds are splash-resistant and can be used during workouts.

TOUCHSCREEN CASE

The touchscreen charging case is easily the most interesting thing about the JBL Live Beam 4. Most charging cases are just a small box that holds your earbuds and tops them up. This one does a little more. From the case itself, you can control playback, volume, noise cancellation modes and EQ. It's a nice touch, and I enjoyed having it around, as it allows me to quickly change songs or modes or nudge the volume up without taking my phone out, but the controls on the earpieces can do the same job.

It does offer some useful features, such as displaying battery levels and notifications. You can also make use of the built-in timer, flashlight, and Find My Buds feature. However, these features aren't valuable enough for me to trade off convenience and portability. On top of that, the screen makes the case bulkier and less pocket-friendly.

If you like having controls and information right at your fingertips, this design could win you over. In simple words, I don't dislike the screen case, but I hope that the future version of the buds doesn't compromise on the size and weight just to fit in an accessory.

SOUND QUALITY

As soon as I put on the buds, the JBL Live Beam 4 makes me want to sit back and let the playlist run. The sound is warm and bass-forward, giving music a rich, full-bodied character without completely overshadowing other elements. Whether it's the weight of the low end or the presence of the vocals, there's an enjoyable balance that makes everyday listening feel effortless.

When I play something with a solid low end, like Aahatein by Agnee, the